

Test 1

READING AND USE OF ENGLISH (1 hour 15 minutes)

Part 1

Questions 1–8

For each question, choose the correct answer.
Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

New views of the sun

Scientists at the National Aeronautical and Space Agency (NASA) in the USA generated great public interest in their work recently, when they **1** an unusual photo. Their satellite had **2** an image they wanted to share, of what **3** to be a happy face on the sun, leading the scientists to describe it as 'smiling'. The experts at NASA explained that when seen in special light, darker **4** on the sun's surface resembled the **5** of a face – two eyes, a nose and a mouth.

But they also explained that the sun can negatively **6** weather in space, and what can be seen in the photos are actually 'coronal holes', from which fast solar wind pours out into space. So **7** the sun's apparently friendly expression, these holes may, in fact, be predicting what's called a solar storm (large amounts of energy leaving the sun's surface). And one **8** of this kind of storm on Earth is to make phenomena such as the Northern Lights more visible in the sky.

- | | | | | |
|---|--------------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1 | A launched | B declared | C released | D proposed |
| 2 | A grabbed | B captured | C gained | D attracted |
| 3 | A regarded | B assumed | C indicated | D appeared |
| 4 | A districts | B ranges | C spheres | D regions |
| 5 | A qualities | B features | C profiles | D factors |
| 6 | A influence | B convert | C exploit | D adapt |
| 7 | A however | B regardless | C despite | D unlike |
| 8 | A product | B conclusion | C effect | D reaction |

Part 2

Questions 9–16

For each question, write the correct answer.

Write **one** word for each gap.

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS on the separate answer sheet.**

Huge artwork in the American state of Nevada

It took American artist Michael Heizer 50 years to complete 'City', his enormous sculpture installation. Situated in a remote desert valley in Nevada, 'City' is 1.5 miles **9** length.

The work takes its inspiration **10** ancient American and Egyptian cities. Its massive structures were built using only local rocks, clay and dirt. These materials were collected with great care in **11** to ensure that native plants were not disturbed.

A trip to 'City' requires planning. Only six tickets, each of which costs \$150, are available daily. Those lucky enough to acquire one must **12** their own way to the town of Alamo. They are then driven to the artwork and are allowed to spend only a few hours admiring it before **13** taken away again. Since the site has **14** streetlights or paved roads at all, visits end well before dark.

Heizer describes 'City' as 'democratic art', but hasn't explained why. 'I am not here to tell people **15** it means. They can figure that out for **16** ,' he told journalists.

Part 3

Questions 17–24

Read the text below. Use the word given in CAPITALS on the right to form a word that fits in the gap.

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Survey into how people find out about new music

A survey was recently carried out into how people find out about new music. It showed that traditional means, such as radio, are still relevant. However, the researchers note that radio listeners are **17** to be under 35 years old, with most being much older.

Given their **18** , it's not surprising that music apps now play the largest role in the **19** of new music worldwide. Video games are also influential, as are social media, which have become a **20** platform for music artists.

Many of the music **21** who responded to the survey mentioned receiving **22** from friends and family, with around a **23** of people saying they hear about new music in this way.

Comparisons between answers from different parts of the world reveal a number of **24** between the USA and Europe, where radio and music apps topped the list, while in Asia, social media were more important,

Keyword List

17 LIKE

18 POPULAR

19 DISCOVER

20 VALUE

21 CONSUME

22 RECOMMEND

23 THREE

24 SIMILAR

Part 4

Questions 25–30

For each question, complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **two** and **five** words, including the word given.

Write **only** the missing words **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

- 25** At the theatre, they insisted that we left our bags in the cloakroom.

MADE

At the theatre, we our bags in the cloakroom.

- 26** We all want sunny weather for our picnic tomorrow.

LIKE

Everyone be a sunny day for our picnic tomorrow.

- 27** The band became more famous because of all the TV appearances they'd made.

GREW

The band's result of all the TV appearances they'd made.

- 28** If you had told me you'd be at the party, I'd have gone too.

AWARE

Had I been to be at the party, I'd have gone too.

- 29 'I'm really sorry I lost your dictionary, Maria,' said John.

APOLOGISED

John her dictionary.

- 30 No one is allowed to take a dog into this park.

MAY

Dogs into this park.

Part 5

Questions 31–36

Read a magazine article about a man called Lewis Pugh, who swam across the Red Sea. For each question, choose the correct answer.

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Swimming across the Red Sea

Lewis Pugh talked to our reporter about his amazing swim.

Above, there was blazing sun. To his right, each time he turned his head to breathe, there was lifeless desert. But below, Lewis Pugh, an experienced long-distance swimmer who was to become the first person to cross the Red Sea from Saudi Arabia to Egypt, saw only life. 'I've never seen anything so spectacular: the rich colours, and the strange and rarely seen tropical fish of every kind – it's a pity more people can't witness it,' he said about the coral reefs he swam over. Not to mention the occasional shark – 'I love sharks,' he told me. 'A shark is a sign of a healthy ocean. But I don't want to be swimming with them.' That was when he took a break on his support boat.

Pugh arrived in Hurghada, Egypt, after 16 days and 160 km. Although he was already well known before he set out, this was for his adventures in the -1.7°C waters of the Arctic and Antarctic. This time, he faced extreme heat, with the water reaching 27°C at times. The motivation for his latest swim was the same as for the others: to highlight the risk climate change poses to some of our most unspoilt environments. 'The biggest changes are in the polar regions and in coral reefs. Both are affected by rising temperatures: the poles are melting and the coral is dying,' he said, adding that this was clear evidence of global warming.

During his crossing, Pugh swam between 6 km and 11 km a day in two daily sessions, climbing aboard the support boat at lunchtime to escape the heat and at night time to sleep. His route began at Tiran Island in the Gulf of Aqaba, and then continued down the Sinai coast. As he swam over some of the longest continuous reefs in the world, he was able to see the massive luxury hotels along the coast where world leaders were due to meet the following month for a global climate summit, to make decisions on which the fate of those reefs might depend. That made him feel particularly emotional, he said.

Scientists fear that coral reefs could be among the hardest-hit ecosystems in a warming world. Reefs can suffer from 'bleaching', when heat stress kills the coral, and can also be damaged by CO_2 in the water. The frequency of bleaching has increased in recent years, but reefs have also **shown resilience**. In 2021, the Great Barrier Reef off Australia bounced back from several bad seasons, with the most coral cover in 36 years. However, marine biologists predict that the majority of tropical coral reefs could disappear, even if global greenhouse-gas emissions are substantially cut.

It was after the reefs that Pugh's biggest challenge began. As he left behind the shallow waters of the Sinai Peninsula, he crossed into the Gulf of Suez. Suddenly, everything changed. It was extremely challenging, exposed as he was to wind, waves and one of the world's busiest shipping lanes, day after day after day. So much so, that he found himself thinking more fondly of his polar adventures. 'Normally, I'm dealing with two risks. When I'm swimming in the Arctic, it could be a polar bear and the cold. In Antarctica, a leopard seal and the cold.' Crossing the Red Sea, though, was on a completely different level. 'You've got the burning hot sun every day. You've got these big container ships and oil tankers coming. I'm being thrown about by these waves. And I've got sharks below me,' he said.

The support boat used an electric shark repellent, but he had to stay close for it to work, which wasn't always easy. But then, as rapidly as the waves appeared, he reached the coast of continental Africa, and they were gone. Suddenly, he was back with the reefs – and their occupants. 'Little gold fish, parrot fish, the most amazing multi-coloured fish,' he said. 'It was such a stark reminder of what we could lose.'

31 What do we learn about Pugh in the first paragraph?

- A He does his best to avoid depressing sights.
- B He hopes that others will take up his sport.
- C He knows little about the animals he has observed.
- D He has mixed feelings about certain sea creatures.

32 What is said about climate change in the second paragraph?

- A Pugh wants people to be in no doubt that it is occurring.
- B It only has an effect in certain parts of the world.
- C There are more aspects of it to investigate.
- D It is an issue that Pugh has only focused on recently.

33 In the third paragraph, what does Pugh suggest he was affected by?

- A the lack of interest in the oceans shown by many countries' governments
- B the harm done to the coastal environment by extensive building work
- C the power that some people have over what happens to the environment
- D the conditions he faced compared with the comfortable accommodation on shore

34 The writer uses the word 'resilience' to describe

- A the ability that some reefs have to recover.
- B a problematic characteristic of some reefs.
- C how damage to some reefs is slowing down.
- D what happens to some reefs in warmer water.

35 What does Pugh say about his experience of swimming in polar seas?

- A He felt particularly threatened by the wildlife.
- B The variety of things he saw kept his mind occupied.
- C There were relatively few things to worry about.
- D It was fairly good preparation for the Red Sea.

36 What feeling is expressed in the final paragraph?

- A surprise at the unpredictable weather conditions
- B concern about the uncertain future of the oceans
- C relief to see that the reefs were looking so healthy
- D disappointment with the protection provided from sharks

Part 6

Questions 37–42

Read a magazine article about birds of prey – birds which catch other birds and animals – called red kites. Six sentences have been removed from the text below. For each question, choose the correct answer. There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

Birds of prey: red kites in England

During the time of the 16th-century English playwright William Shakespeare, a common sight on London's streets was the red kite, one of my favourite birds. These birds were so common, in fact, that Shakespeare referred to London as a 'city of kites and crows' and wrote about their rather unusual habit of constructing their nests using strange objects – including items of washing hanging outside to dry.

Since that time, the number of red kites has declined dramatically. However, following a recent reintroduction programme in England, there are now almost 2,000 breeding pairs in the country. **37** And that's a tremendous achievement.

My interest in red kites began several years ago when, for some reason, my garden began to be inspected every morning by a pair of these magnificent birds. Usually, the first indication that they are around is the sight of them high up in the sky, having a long, cool look at me and my garden. I've observed the kite more closely than any other bird of prey, so I'm totally familiar with its movements. **38** And the amazing shallow M-shape it makes with its wings as it does this is also very distinctive. But only when it approaches do you realise it's actually much bigger than it seems from a distance.

As for how it looks, its body is extraordinarily beautiful, with sleek bronze feathers and powerful

claws. **39** What's more, if you were ever lucky enough to get close to it, you'd be able to observe its eyes: cloud-pale and sharp.

And on windy days, I've even seen red kites playing, when I've been in my study. One of the pair living close to me often begins a long, slow ascent, in which each hard-fought wingbeat is a steep, deep movement. Then at what appears to be a completely random height, it goes into what seems to be a freefall dive. **40** This involves the outermost wing feathers making constant tiny adjustments, lifting and lowering. Watching it all, I marvel at the bird's mastery of flight.

However, this flexibility in its wings is nothing compared with the workings of the kite's very impressive tail, which has two parts, similar to the tail of a plane, and helps to control direction. At times, these almost seem to operate independently. The right part goes off at an angle while the left holds still. **41** There are also moments of perfect symmetry when the two parts are spread flat like the pages of an open book.

I know of no birds that represent the wonders of nature as effectively as red kites. **42** However, views of this bird are now far more widely accessible than that, thanks largely to what may turn out to be the most successful, most exhilarating reintroduction of our lifetimes; it seems we can all catch kite fever.

- A** Yet despite appearances, from my observation point I can see it steering a perfectly controlled course.
- B** Watching this miracle of the world of wildlife was once reserved only for those who lived in remote locations.
- C** There's that strange way it flies, for one thing, so slow it's almost wobbling in the air at times.
- D** As a result, they're more frequently seen these days, compared with even 30 years ago.
- E** Though the local starlings, much smaller birds, usually sound the alarm at signs of danger, they make no fuss when the kite shows up.
- F** Sometimes when the light picks up the underside of its wings, as it rests high up in trees ready for its next flight, you also catch a flash of white.
- G** And these roles can be reversed in an instant.

Part 7

Questions 43–52

Read an article about teenage climbers. For each question, choose the correct section. Each section may be chosen more than once.

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Teenage climbers

Four teenagers talk about their love of climbing.

A Hitomi Ogawa (aged 15)

When I was eight, my class visited a climbing centre with an indoor climbing wall, and I absolutely loved it. Neither of my parents is particularly sporty, and I was small for my age, so you can understand why it hadn't occurred to them that climbing might appeal to me. But once they realised I was determined to become really good at it, they were very supportive. Before long, I was practising three evenings a week, and at weekends my parents were taking me to climbing competitions. I've got to know many friends from different backgrounds through climbing, which my parents regard as a good thing, and I do, too. If they ever think the climbing is affecting my other activities, they'll tell me, and I now know how to manage my time in a way I didn't use to – going out more and getting homework done, as well as pursuing this hobby. Actually, my parents think what I've learnt in this respect will serve me well in whatever career I end up in, though we'll have to see how true that is.

B Dylan Jameson (aged 17)

I mainly do indoor wall climbing rather than rock climbing, and I'm in the top 20 competitive climbers in the country. That might sound impressive, and my parents and teachers are proud of what I've managed to do, but I want to get into the top ten. I train every day and compete at weekends, which means I don't get to hang out with my friends or play basketball as much as I'd like, which is a pity. But I do get things from climbing that have wider benefits – for my studies, for example. My concentration and my ability to solve problems have both improved considerably. I'm actually taking a month's break from climbing right now. The last time I competed, I completely lost my temper after I'd made a big mistake. That happens occasionally, and when it does, my coaches say I need a break from training and competing. That's disappointing to hear, but I always follow their advice.

C Paula Suarez (aged 19)

This year, I became one of the youngest-ever women to climb Mount Everest, and my story was widely reported. I've decided to take advantage of my high profile, especially on social media, to speak out about ice and snow disappearing from the mountains because of global warming. I've been climbing mountains since I was six. This might seem amazingly young, but both my parents are rock climbers, and they've always encouraged me to think anything is possible. Not everyone's like that, though. I've been on expeditions where fellow climbers have been worried that, being a young, slender-looking woman, I'll just hold them back. That attitude gets on my nerves, and I'm always delighted to prove just how good a climber I am. When I'm not climbing, I study hard, and I also keep fit by doing lots of running. To squeeze everything in, I devote a lot of time and energy to working out what I should aim for in the near- and medium-term, and how I can achieve it.

D Kevin Schwarz (aged 19)

Last year, I climbed up the outside of a 95-storey building in the centre of London, solo and without ropes. All the main TV channels and newspapers reported the story, it was all over social media, and I gained thousands of followers. I was described as a representative of a new generation of extreme climbers, setting a good example for them to follow, which isn't something I've ever really wanted to take on. My aim was more to see how much the human body and mind is capable of. I spent eight months preparing for the climb, and in that time, I didn't see any family or friends at all; I just trained and visualised what I was going to do. The idea was to reach an ideal physical and psychological state in which I don't have to analyse my every movement – I just do it completely naturally, somewhat like a cat climbing a tree. And I'm very pleased to say that I've succeeded in accomplishing precisely that.

Which person

feels uncomfortable with the idea of being a role model for others?	43
has got better at achieving a balance between climbing and other aspects of life?	44
admits getting angry with themselves at times?	45
thinks that skills developed through climbing can help them with school work?	46
aims to use climbing to raise awareness of an important issue?	47
appreciates having had the opportunity to widen their social circle?	48
is irritated by certain assumptions that some people have?	49
likes to be able to climb without thinking much about what they're doing?	50
suggests it seems surprising that they became interested in climbing?	51
regrets missing out on certain activities because of climbing?	52

WRITING (1 hour 20 minutes)

Part 1

Question 1

You **must** answer this question.

Write your answer in **140–190 words** in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1** In your English class you have been talking about keeping up to date with the latest fashion in clothes. Now, your English teacher has asked you to write an essay.

Write your essay using **all** the notes and giving reasons for your point of view.

**‘Young people need to keep up to date with the latest fashion in clothes.’
Do you agree?**

Notes

Write about:

- expressing their personality
- effect on the environment
- (your own idea)

Part 2

Questions 2–4

Write an answer to **one** of the questions in this part.

Write your answer in **140–190 words** in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

Put the question number in the box at the top of the answer sheet.

- 2 This is an email you have received from your English-speaking friend, Kim:

Subject: Learning your language!

Hi!

Thanks for inviting me to stay with you this summer. I've never been to your country before, so I want to learn a bit of your language before I arrive. What's the best way to learn it quickly? What do you think I'll find most difficult?

Kim

Write your **email**.

- 3 You see this announcement in an online English-language magazine:

Articles wanted

A CHANGE FOR THE BETTER

Have you made a change that has improved your life? It could be a change in your studies, your leisure interests or something else.

What change did you make, and how has it improved your life?

Is it important for people to make changes in their lives?

The best articles will be posted on our website.

Write your **article**.

- 4 You have seen this announcement in an English-language magazine:

Stories wanted

We are looking for stories for our new English-language magazine for teenagers. Your story must **begin** with this sentence:

Jo was astonished to see an old school friend on TV.

Your story must include:

- a phone call
- a meeting.

Write your **story**.

LISTENING (approximately 40 minutes)

Part 1

Questions 1–8

For each question, choose the correct answer.

You hear two friends discussing a television programme about an unusual fashion designer.

What do they agree about her clothes?

- A** It's good that they're environmentally friendly.
- B** It's a shame that they're so expensive.
- C** It'd be fun to try wearing them.

2 You hear a science teacher talking to a class about the possibility of life on other planets.

What is she doing?

- A** explaining why people underestimate the chances of finding life
- B** pointing out that life may be found in unexpected places
- C** emphasising how recent discoveries help the search for life

3 You hear two friends talking about the possibility of having a career in gaming.

What does the girl say about it?

- A** It would take a great deal of effort.
- B** It would provide a range of opportunities.
- C** It would be difficult to make a living from.

4 You hear two friends talking about a film they have just seen.

What do they agree?

- A** The music was exceptionally good.
- B** The actors were very impressive.
- C** The story was funnier than they expected.

5 You hear a radio item about a prize-winning map.**What point does the presenter make about the map?**

- A** It gives a realistic view of the size of different areas.
- B** It will eventually replace traditional maps in classrooms.
- C** It will be easier for travellers to use.

6 You hear a girl talking to a friend about taking part in a photography competition.**What does she say about it?**

- A** She knew the standard of work would be high.
- B** She wasn't confident about her entry.
- C** She needed a lot of patience to get the right shot.

7 You hear a teacher talking to students about not being able to finish certain novels.**What advice does he give the students?**

- A** Failing to read the books in no way indicates they lack intelligence.
- B** Not every book will be worth the effort of trying to read it.
- C** They may find their reaction to difficult books changes over time.

8 You hear a man on the radio talking about a street-art festival.**What does he say about it?**

- A** Artists will attempt to reflect the city's culture in their work.
- B** Visitors will have a different experience, depending on when they go.
- C** There will be a range of exhibitions to celebrate its anniversary.

Part 2

Questions 9–18

You will hear a teenager called Henry giving a class presentation about his interest in meteorology – the study of weather. For each question, write the correct answer. Write a word or short phrase.

My interest in the weather

A fear of **9** led to Henry's interest in meteorology.

Meeting other members of an online group showed Henry that he wasn't as **10** as he'd thought.

Henry thinks that **11** is something that amateur forecasters are more able to provide than professionals.

Henry says that **12** when making forecasts appeals more to amateur forecasters than professionals.

Henry feels that the best weather instrument to make is one which measures **13**

Henry explains that a lack of **14** makes most weather apps unreliable.

Henry mentions **15** as an example of a type of weather he struggles to predict.

Henry admits that his best predictions in a weather forecasting competition relied on **16**

Henry only recently found out that a good understanding of **17** is necessary for studying meteorology at university.

Henry is hoping to get a job as a **18** when he's older.

Part 3

Questions 19–23

You will hear five short extracts in which teenagers are talking about an after-school hip-hop dance class. What does each speaker say about the class?

For each question, choose the correct answer.

Use each answer only once. There are three extra answers which you do not need to use.

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------|---|
| Speaker 1 | 19 | A It's enjoyable to do something as a change from team sports. |
| Speaker 2 | 20 | B I appreciate the teacher's attitude towards the students. |
| Speaker 3 | 21 | C The other dancers are particularly encouraging. |
| Speaker 4 | 22 | D It's provided a challenge I hadn't expected. |
| Speaker 5 | 23 | E I'm grateful for the opportunity to improve my fitness. |
| | | F The people are unaware of the history of the dance. |
| | | G It's increased my awareness of the background to the style of dance. |
| | | H It seems a good way to relax after school. |

Part 4

Questions 24–30

You will hear a young man called Mark Lowe talking about his career in synchronised diving, a sport where divers perform dives in pairs. For each question, choose the correct answer.

24 What inspired Mark to take up the sport of synchronised diving?

- A a talk he heard a famous sports person giving
- B watching diving events at the Olympic Games on TV
- C a family member's enthusiasm for another water sport

25 How has Mark's attitude to training changed over the last year?

- A He is better able to manage his feelings of frustration.
- B He takes more pleasure in routine aspects of it.
- C He is more determined to use his time efficiently.

26 What does Mark say about his relationship with his diving partner?

- A They differ in their ambitions for the future.
- B They regularly have small differences of opinion.
- C They have very different personalities from one another.

27 How did Mark feel after winning his first national competition?

- A reluctant to return to his previous schedule
- B amazed at how exciting it was
- C pleased to be receiving publicity

28 Mark says that since taking on some coaching responsibilities he has become

- A a lot more serious than before.
- B better at explaining himself than before.
- C physically fitter than before.

29 Why did Mark decide to compete in a solo diving event?

- A** He was eager to have a new challenge.
- B** He wanted to have more control over his life.
- C** He hoped to succeed as an individual performer.

30 How did Mark feel about his experience at the solo diving event?

- A** He was satisfied that he had done his best.
- B** He was surprised how much he missed having a partner.
- C** He was encouraged by the spectators' response.